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[00:14:42] The House will come to order. Members, please take your seats. Head page. The House is now in session. All persons not entitled to privileges to the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:15:01] The members will rise and be led in prayer by the Honorable Wendell Walker, Delegate, and remain standing for the Pledge of Allegiance of the Flag of the United States of America, which will be led by the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Before I pray, I'd like to share one verse from the Scriptures, and that is 2 Chronicles 7.14. You may be familiar with this.

[00:15:26] But if my people who are called by my name shall humble themselves, pray, and seek my face, and then turn from their wicked ways, then I will hear from heaven, I will forgive their sins, and heal their lands. Shall we pray? Heavenly Fathers, we come before you today. We come with grateful and thankful hearts for life, for your love to us, for what you mean in our lives, dear Lord. We thank you for your forgiveness. We seek your guidance and direction each and every

[00:16:02] day in our life. Thank you for the freedoms and the liberties we have here as citizens of this country in the Commonwealth of Virginia. So dear Lord, as we go about our day to day, the decisions that we make are going to have an impact on the lives of our citizens, our constituents out here.

[00:16:21] So we seek your wisdom and we ask for your guidance and direction so that what we say and do will always bring honor and glory to you. Father, we ask that you fill our hearts with your Holy spirit your encouragement your guidance direction and father we do want to lift up of the night of our delegate night family today paula and all of those as they're going through this time of grieving lord comfort their hearts be near and dear to them and we just pray for their services coming up this weekend so lord we just again come to you with grateful and thankful hearts

[00:16:56] may all that we do and say today bring honor and glory to our precious savior in whose name we pray Amen. Amen. I pledge allegiance to the flag of the United States of America, to the republic for one nation.

[00:17:25] The members will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board.

[00:17:55] Clerk will close the roll. Mr. Speaker, a quorum is present. Pursuant to House Rule 3, I've examined and approved the Journal of the House of Delegates for February 24, 2026. Motions and resolutions under Rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40 are now in order. Does the clerk have any announcements or communications?

[00:18:11] No communications at this time. a simple announcement this is budget week we will take up the budget tomorrow the deadline for floor amendments was today at noon we have received four floor amendments which will be processed as soon as we get off the floor and be made available later this afternoon also just remind the members the process of procedures email and documentation is out there to you so if you're going to object to something the first deadline for objections is tomorrow at 11 a.m Pursuant to House Rule 40, the Speaker requests you use your request to speak button for the agenda items listed for reference up on the voting board.

[00:18:46] Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Torian. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of motion. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that House Bill 30 be made a special and continuing order for Thursday, February 26, 2026 at the conclusion of the fourth morning hour.

[00:19:04] The delegate from Prince William, Delegatorian, moves that House Bill 30 be made a special and continuing order for Thursday, February 26, 2026, at the conclusion of the fourth morning hour. Shall the motion be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. My apologies.

[00:19:19] Recorded vote. Madam Clerk. Trying to help y'all back here. I'm trying to help the folks in the kitchen. See what I mean? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:19:43] Ayes 93, no zero. Ayes 93, no zero. The motion is agreed to. The delegate from Bonita, Delegate Austin. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an announcement. that Doug has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. As we approach our nation's 250th birthday this July the 4th, formerly known as the semi-quincentennial, I rise as chairman of the VA 250 Commission to share a unique opportunity available to each of you just outside of the chamber. Parked on Bank Street next to the Capitol Annex is the VA 250 Mobile Museum,

[00:20:18] an impressive 1,100 square foot traveling exhibit that brings Virginia's founding history to life. This state-of-the-art mobile museum has traveled across the Commonwealth and highlights Virginia's central role in the birth of our nation, featuring immersive displays and interactive exhibits and a holographic presentation of Patrick Henry's delivering his immortal words, give me liberty or give me death.

[00:20:44] We have two of these mobile museums that will visit each middle school in Virginia. The road tractors pulling the museum was built by Virginians at the Volvo plant in Dublin and was generously donated by the company.

[00:21:01] As we continue our work here in the oldest continuous lawmaking body in the Western Hemisphere, it is fitting that we take a moment to reflect on the extraordinary leadership and sacrifice that began here in Virginia. I encourage each of you to join my fellow commission members, Delegates Askew, Kresik, and along with Delegate Bouliva to take a few minutes to tour the exhibit and experience firsthand the powerful story of Virginia's role in securing America's independence.

[00:21:32] After all, Virginia was made in America. Mr. Speaker, I now yield the remainder of my time to Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Askew. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Askew. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I'll rise briefly to share a couple of additional updates on the upcoming Juneteenth celebration and African Landing Day commemoration at Virginia 250 signature event.

[00:21:54] As we continue to commemorate America's 250th, I want to note that communities across the Commonwealth will mark Juneteenth with celebrations, educational programs, concerts, and family-friendly events that honor black freedom, resilience, and culture. I encourage Virginians to visit the Virginia 250 website to learn more and to find information about Juneteenth events happening in their localities.

[00:22:15] Also, Mr. Speaker, I'd like to share an update about the upcoming African Landing Day commemoration at Fort Monroe planned for August 2026 at the VA 250 signature event. Fort Monroe marks the site where the first recorded Africans arrived in English, North America in 1619 at a founding moment in the American history.

[00:22:36] This event is currently in the planning stage. We are working with partners to thoroughly and thoughtfully shape a commemoration and a finalizing date that will be shared once we confirm that date. America, Made in Virginia, is about telling the full story of our origins, including complex chapters.

[00:22:51] These events will complement other signature events across the Commonwealth by ensuring the semi-quincentennial reflects the breadth of America's finding experience. Ms. Speaker, I want to defer the rest of my time to Delegate Creason. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Creasy.

[00:23:07] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Thank you, Delegate Askew and Chairman Austin. This spring, on April 24th and 25th, we will gather at Colonial Williamsburg for the first of the signature events of this semi-quincentennial commemoration. The theme is both timely and timeless, inspiring a season of civic renewal.

[00:23:26] As the birthplace of so many of our nation's democratic institutions, Virginia is a natural place to begin America's 250th anniversary. but just as important as where we begin is how we begin. We in Virginia are centering this historic commemoration on the story of our tribal nations and their inherent sovereignty.

[00:23:48] That choice reflects a simple but powerful truth that civic renewal begins with telling the full and truthful story of our nation's founding. Long before 1776, tribal nations governed themselves on this continent. They developed sophisticated systems of diplomacy, law, representation, consensus building.

[00:24:07] They entered into treaties. They defended their lands. They exercised sovereignty, not as a gift from any other government, but as an inherent right in that sovereignty endures today. Tribal nations are sovereign governments with enduring rights and treaty relationships with the United States.

[00:24:24] Recognizing that reality is not an act of charity. It's an act of constitutional fidelity and historical honesty. We acknowledge that indigenous governance helped shape the democratic ideas that became foundational to the United States.

[00:24:40] The Haudenosaunee Confederacy, also known as the Iroquois Confederacy, offers a model of federalism, representative leadership, and balance of powers that influence early American thinkers. As we celebrate 250 years of American democracy, it is fitting that we honor those intellectual and political contributions.

[00:24:59] this gathering is not about just the past. This program will examine federal Indian policy from the earliest days of the Republic to the present. It will not shy away from hard truths about removal, assimilation, broken treaties, and the long struggle for recognition and self-determination.

[00:25:16] Historical honesty is not divisive. It is clarifying. It allows us to see where we've fallen short and where we must do better. And it allows us, most importantly, Mr. Speaker, to look forward. The event in Colonial Williamsburg will conclude with solutions-focused dialogue about the future, about federal, state, and tribal governments, how they can strengthen the government-to-government relationships, expand economic opportunity, protect cultural heritage, and ensure that tribal sovereignty is respected in practice as well as principle.

[00:25:52] The national significance of this convening cannot be overstated. We will bring together tribal leaders, scholars, policymakers, and youth voices from across Indian Country. We will hear dinner remarks from Virginia's own United States Senators Mark Warner and Tim Kaine, and we will have as our keynote address from Neil Gorsuch, whose jurisprudence has underscored the importance of honoring tribal treaty rights and respecting tribal sovereignty under the rule of law.

[00:26:23] It reflects something deeper than politics, a shared commitment to the constitutional framework of our nation and to the principle that governments must keep their word the broader message of virginia 250 is clear america made in virginia it's about educating engaging inspiring civic renewal thank you mr speaker i look forward to seeing you all in colonial williamsburg this april as we begin america's 250th celebration in 2026 delegate from jiles county delegate ballot

[00:27:00] thank you mr speaker mr speaker i rise for the purpose of an introduction the delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, members of the House. As Delegates, Austin, Askew, and Cresick just mentioned, outside today in Capitol Square is the Virginia American Revolution 250 Mobile Museum, and I am very proud to say that the museum is being towed by a Volvo truck built in my district in Dublin, Virginia, in the 42nd House District. Mr. Speaker, joining us in the gallery today are employees of Volvo and members of the United Auto Workers, and I ask that they please stand. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, the plant in Dublin is Volvo's largest truck

[00:27:38] manufacturing facility in the world, and the company has invested more than $760 million in the plant since 2011. The plant employs almost 3,000 people and is where all of Volvo's trucks for the North American market are built. Near the end of last year, Mr. Speaker, Volvo Trucks North America presented

an all-new Volvo VNL860, which is the company's flagship sleeper truck to the VA250 Commission for use with its mobile museum. Mr. Speaker, members of the House,

[00:28:12] I ask that we give the Volvo employees in Volvo America a very warm house welcome.

[00:28:29] Welcome. Welcome to the capital of the day. The elect from Chesterfield, Delegate Gartner. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor.

[00:28:40] Today, thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today in the gallery, we have guests from Bryant and Stratton College. Would they please stand? Thank you. Founded in 1854, Bryant and Stratton is a not-for-profit, middle-state-accredited career college. For over 170 years, the institution has demonstrated a steadfast commitment to meeting the evolving needs of students and the modern workforce.

[00:29:12] While primarily an associate degree-granting institution, Bryant & Stratton offers a comprehensive range of certificates, diplomas, associates, and bachelor's degree pathways. As of fall 2025, Bryant & Stratton served approximately 17,000 students across 16 campuses and an online division.

[00:29:36] The Richmond Chesterfield campus is the largest in the system, serving 1,200 students. In 2025 alone, this campus produced 373 graduates for the Commonwealth. We are honored to have Bryan and Stratton leadership teams present today.

[00:29:53] They are joined by the dedicated representatives from their career services, admissions, instruction, and nursing departments. Please join me in giving them a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:30:17] Delegate from Spotsylvania, Delegate Scott. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Joining us today is the Orange Youth Council, if they'd please rise. Mr. Speaker, this group of young men and women are incredible. They are incredible because not only are they here today to learn more about the legislative process, but they are incredible because they are courageous to speak up for what they believe in, to challenge, and to speak out for those who can't speak out for themselves.

[00:30:46] Mr. Speaker, one of the things that this wonderful group of young individuals has been very passionate about over the past several years that I've been here in this amazing assembly is wanting to restrict access to nicotine and vape products for minors. They advocate on having these shops far away from schools. They advocate on stricter rules and regulations to make it harder for them to get.

[00:31:12] They support delegate hopes legislation for the mystery shoppers to make sure that it's not going to minors. These are some of the things that they are very passionate about and, again, that they have spoken to on a regular basis. Additionally, they came with questions for me on legislation that I presented this year to question and try to figure out a better understanding of my approach, even though they may not have necessarily agreed with my approach on the topic. They're well-informed, very educated, and some of the best and brightest that the Commonwealth has to offer. And so, Mr. Speaker, on behalf of Delegate Hamilton and myself, I ask the House to give them a warm House welcome.

[00:31:57] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Loughton County, Delegate Singh. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction, a request, and two motions. Nobody likes a show-off, kid. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I'd like to introduce someone who needs no introduction to this body, Secretary

of Natural and Historic Resources David Bouliva and his daughter Josette, and I ask the House give them a warm welcome.

[00:32:34] Welcome back, Secretary Bouliva. Shouldn't you be somewhere working or something? All right, all right, go ahead. Mr. Speaker, I request that we call up HJ165, not on today's calendar. The clerk will report a resolution. House Joint Resolution No. 165, celebrating the life of Lieutenant Colonel Richard Thomas Boulevard, U.S.A.R.

[00:32:57] The delegate from Loudoun County. Delegate C. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of H.J. 165 and further move that when we adjourn, we do so in the honor and memory of Richard Thomas Boulevard, and I'd like to speak to those motions. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, Lieutenant Colonel Richard Thomas Boliva, Dick as he was known to his friends, was an active and beloved member of our Northern Virginia community.

[00:33:21] Born in Syracuse, New York, he joined the Army and served in Germany. After a second tour of duty, he relocated to Washington, D.C. to serve as a civilian in the Department of the Army as a project engineer, developing night vision and counter surveillance technology.

[00:33:37] He was a physicist, a self-described mad scientist. Not only did he love science, he loved teaching science. He would teach neighborhood kids how electricity worked using car batteries. No one was hurt in those demonstrations. He would do night vision demonstrations in high school classrooms, and he would provoke you to think.

[00:33:59] He would take outrageous positions at the dinner table and challenge you to refute them. He believed in being active in the community. He would judge science fairs, volunteered at the hospital, performed weddings, was a member of the American Legion.

[00:34:15] He was a bowler, a photographer, loved wine tasting, and had a huge circle of friends. But more importantly, he has a loving family. He is the father of our very own former Delegate David Boliva and Karin Johansson, who lives in Seattle with her husband and sons.

[00:34:32] He is the father-in-law of our very own Delegate Gretchen Boliva. He has five beloved grandchildren and will be fondly remembered and dearly missed by his loving wife, Anne Lise. Mr. Speaker, on December 29, 2025, we lost this great man.

[00:34:47] But the Commonwealth is better off because of his contributions. Therefore, Mr. Speaker, on behalf of Delegate Gretchen Bolivar and myself, we move that when we adjourn, we do so in the honor and memory of Richard Thomas Bolivar, and we move the adoption of H.J. 165, a resolution commemorating his life and legacy.

[00:35:06] The delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Singh, moves the adoption of House Joint Resolution No. 165 and that when the House adjourns today, it adjourned in the honor and memory of Lieutenant Colonel Richard Thomas Boulevard. All those in favor shall rise.

[00:35:27] The motion is agreed to.

[00:35:40] Delegate from Hanover, Delegate Fowler. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction.

[00:35:55] The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, Delegate Cousins, I would like to introduce students from the Randolph Rising Leaders Program and their Executive Director, Lloyd Young.

[00:36:12] Can you go, would you all please rise? Thank you, Mr. Chairman. Members of the House, the school is in my district in Henrico County. The River City Dreams and Academy of Virginia Randolph prepares students for leadership skills beyond high school.

[00:36:31] This started with the dream to impact the Ryko, Virginia area through quality education, spiritual impartation, and community collaboration. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, I hope you'll join me in giving them a warm house welcome.

[00:36:51] Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. The Delegate from Lawton County, Delegate Reed. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. Delegate, that's the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Joining us in the gallery today is Electrify Virginia Partnership for E-Mobility Day at the Capitol.

[00:37:12] If they could please rise. Electrify Virginia is a statewide campaign involving communities, government, businesses, and EV advocates to promote the benefits of electric vehicles across the Commonwealth. Over the past year, the partnership has hosted 26 events where they engage leaders, students, drivers, and communities across Virginia.

[00:37:33] Today's events highlight how transportation electrification improves public health, reduces emissions, and supports economic growth. Their commitment to building strong communities and advancing sustainable transportation is truly commendable. I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to give them a warm house welcome.

[00:37:53] Welcome. Welcome in the Capitol today. Delegate from Richmond County, Delegate Kent. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate, ask the floor. Thank you. Today, Mr. Speaker, we are honored to have students and teachers from Lancaster High School.

[00:38:12] I'd ask that they please rise. This is our good-looking group of government students that have traveled far from the Northern Act to our Capitol to get a firsthand look at their government at work. This fall, I had the opportunity to go to that classroom and see their own bill presentations, their mock debates, and really see how our process works.

[00:38:36] Their visit today certainly reflects a great commitment to civic engagement and learning beyond the classroom. We're grateful for them and their teachers for making the trip up here, and I've asked that the house please give them a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Thornton.

[00:39:04] Good morning, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today we are joined virtually by the members of the Virginia Dealer Association. With over 450 new car dealer members that are part of the Virginia Dealer Association, they employ over 35,000 of our constituents and represent one of the largest segments of our retail segment in our economy.

[00:39:31] Today we will be joined by these legislators as they go throughout the assembly, meeting with legislators and discussing the benefits of the franchise system and how it benefits our commonwealth. I ask you to please join me in giving them a warm House welcome.

[00:39:51] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Rockingham, Delegate Wilk. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the introduction. The Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Ladies and gentlemen of the House, today with us in the gallery are some friends from James Madison University, I asked that they would stand. Mr. Speaker, we're joined in the gallery by two classes from James Madison

University, Professor Joel Hensley's Virginia Government course and Dr. Lily Peasley's Senior Seminar and Public Policy course. I'll note that

[00:40:31] Professor Hensley is a supervisor in my district and my former legislative aide when I first came into office. They're visiting the Capitol today, meeting not only with legislators, but clerk and agency staff to get a diverse and in-depth understanding of the legislative process from all facets. I ask that you join me in giving them a warm house welcome. Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a motion. The

[00:41:10] delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that Senate Bill 123 on page 14 be referred to the Committee on Privileges and Elections. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price moves that Senate Bill 123, found on page 14, be re-referred to the Committee on Privilege and Elections. All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Senate Bill 123 on page 14 is re-referred to the Committee on Privilege and Elections. So into House Rule 20, House Rule 30, the journal shall reflect that the following members are away on pressing personal business. I'm going to leave

[00:41:45] from today's session. Delegate Griffin. The clerk will announce the next order. Mr. Speaker, the second portion of the morning hour is reserved for the announcement of member requests for legislation to be moved from uncontested calendar to the regular. There are seven in that first category once we get into business.

[00:42:01] Senate Bill's third reading, uncontested calendar. Page 1, Senator Ayers, SB 3, at the request of Delegate Wyatt, out of the block, over to the regular calendar. Page 2, Senator Malkhais, SB 88, over to the regular calendar, request of Delegate Tram. Down further on page 2, Senator Locke's SB 134 over to the regular calendar.

[00:42:24] Page 3, Senator McPike's SB 140, both of those to the request of Delegate Wyatt. Page 5, Senator Aird's SB 286 out of the block to the regular calendar at request of Delegate Tran. And on page 7, Senator Lucas's SB 403 is to the regular calendar.

[00:42:44] And on page 9, Senator French's SB 800 is over to the regular calendar. Both of those who are at the request of Delegate Wyatt. Clerk will announce the next order of business. The third portion of the morning hour is reserved for member requests. Let's just go by for the day. I'm not aware of any such requests today.

[00:43:01] Clerk will announce the next order of business. And the fourth and final portion of the morning hour is reserved for member requests for points of personal privilege. The Speaker kind of asks you to request the speak button to get into the queue. Delegate from Buckingham, Delegate Garrett. Mr. Speaker, I rise on the point of personal privilege. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, first thing I want to do is thank you for giving me this opportunity.

[00:43:19] I also want to thank my colleague from Fairfax who said earlier this morning, historical honesty is not divisive, it's clarifying. Mr. Speaker, I want to point, I want to start this point of personal privilege by pointing people to 1 John 2, 9 through 11. 1 John 2, 9 through 11. Man, that is, that's a punch to the gut Bible verse that I have read and reread so that I can learn from it.

[00:43:43] And I hope that everybody that watches this will. Mr. Speaker, I rise to say this. I love history. I love my neighbor. I love the Constitution, Mr. Speaker. I love you, and I've learned from every one of those

four things, and I'm going to touch on those. Seventy years ago on this day, Senator Harry Byrd started massive resistance in Virginia.

[00:44:07] There's no defense of it. The last time a General Assembly kicked off a session by changing the Constitution immediately upon a convening was 70 years ago. Mr. Speaker, somebody smarter than me once said history doesn't repeat itself, but sometimes it rhymes.

[00:44:25] We did that this January, seven years later. When they did it, they said they had to do it because of what had been done in Washington, D.C. What was done in Washington, D.C.? The ruling was issued in the case of Brown v. Board of Education. Now, I hear that we have to change our Constitution in Virginia again because of what's happened in D.C., without regard to what's been happening for years in Massachusetts or Illinois or Connecticut or any other number of states.

[00:44:52] I'm told that we have to change our Constitution, which we changed five years ago, under the promise that we'll change it back again as soon as we're done. Mr. Speaker, the federal Constitution has been changed 17 times in about 250 years. Really, it's been changed 15 times because we changed it twice so that we could once change it back.

[00:45:12] The founders in the preamble said we are tasked with founding a more perfect union. I love that brilliance, Mr. Speaker. I love it because the word more is included with the recognition of the truth found in Romans 3.23, that all have sinned and come short of the glory of God.

[00:45:28] We stink, we fail, and yet we strive to be better. And so that word more is important because it recognizes that we will never get it right, but we have a duty to try to get it right. The point of a constitution is not to change, right?

[00:45:45] But imperfect people gave us near-perfect ideas, and in so doing, they gave us the mechanism to change constitutions. Mr. Speaker, America will be tested. Virginia will be tested.

[00:46:02] We have been tested so many times. We were tested during a revolution. We were tested during a civil war in which brother fought against brother, almost three-quarters of a million people laying down their lives in the fight over a fundamental truth that no man should be better than another man and indeed isn't in the eyes of our creator.

[00:46:20] And a very impressive man, Mr. Speaker, once told me, if you've never been tested, how are you going to have a testimony? I know you know who that man was, Mr. Speaker. It was you. And that stuck with me because you and I, we've been tested just like our nation, just like our commonwealth.

[00:46:37] And I think that both of us have come out of it better. So America has and will been tested. And we're being tested now. We're being tested 70 years ago today when Virginia Democrats started massive resistance. They did it to ensure that minority voices would not be heard.

[00:46:53] It's the truth. It's the truth. Seventy years later, or 70 years ago, the majorities in both chambers were far bigger. The governor's mansion was occupied by the same party. And then, like today in Virginia, we were responding to what had happened in D.C. Here's the good news, though.

[00:47:10] And I'll paraphrase Dr. King, who paraphrased an abolitionist. The arc of justice tends to bend, or the arc of history tends to bend towards justice. The good news is that the founders, imperfect though they were, gave us a mechanism to deal injustice. Just like massive resistance failed as it should have, if

America is working to form a more perfect union, this too will fail. Note that it took decades. It took decades for that to fail.

[00:47:36] Note that a former Democratic Klansman and Senator, also named Byrd, personally spoke for 14 hours and 13 minutes in a filibuster against the Voting Rights Act. And note that this happened in 1964, but that the Democrat nominee for president in 2016 called him a friend and a mentor, a man of whom America should be proud. Note that even now, people seem to seek to remedy discrimination that everyone knows was wrong. Everyone knows it was wrong with discrimination that everyone should know is wrong. Everyone should know it's wrong.

[00:48:14] Mr. Speaker, John Adams said our constitution was made holy for a moral and religious people, and it's inadequate for the government of any other. But are we a moral people? Am I? Are you? The point of testimony isn't the testimony. The point of testimony is what we learn from testimony. What did we learn the last time the Constitution of Virginia was changed to disenfranchise a minority of people? What did we learn? Mr. Speaker, I know what I learned.

[00:48:46] What I learned is why I started this presentation with 1 John 2, 9 through 11. That's what I learned. What I learned is what I learned from two amazing philosophers from whom I was privileged to learn my mom and dad.

[00:49:02] And I think what I learned is the same thing that everybody in this room has learned at some point. And that is that no matter how bad it was, no matter how bad it was, we have a duty to be better and simply put, Mr. Speaker, two wrongs don't make a right. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:49:20] The delegate from Suffolk, Delegate Clark. Mr. Speaker, I rise toward a point of personal privilege. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:49:35] In honor of Black History Month, I've come to deliver my annual truth report. And Mr. Speaker, the truth is the commonwealth in this nation needs compassion and love. Now, compassion is the active desire to alleviate another's suffering, whereas love is the broader, deep feeling of affection and the desire of another's happiness.

[00:49:56] So now that we understand what these words mean, let me provide examples where compassion and love lacked historically. Let's start first with remembering. Remembering the 246 years of slavery, the 81 years of being three-fifths of a person, and the 89 years of segregation.

[00:50:16] Mr. Speaker, let me break that down to show how black people are still being impacted by the decisions of legislative bodies of the past. Mr. Speaker, my parents was born in the 60s when the fight for civil rights and voting rights was originally one, but still had to combat inequality, mass incarceration and the war on drugs, redlining police brutality, the three strikes law, the widening wealth gap.

[00:50:41] Mr. Speaker, singer-songwriter Marvin Gaye should not have had to sing Mother, Mother, is too many of you crying, and Brother, Brother, is too many of you dying, while black people still had to navigate the social, economic, and educational inequalities that were passed down from their parents.

[00:50:59] Where was the compassion? My four grandparents were born throughout the 30s and 40s when black people faced economic exclusion and poverty, Jim Crow segregation, widespread racial violence, and segregation in military services, which my granddad served in the Navy. They saw systemic political disenfranchisement, also known as the political blackout, that lasted for about 80 years.

[00:51:29] My grandparents were 10 years older than me by the first time they saw an elected black leader on the state or federal level. Mr. Speaker's singer-songwriter Sam Cooke wouldn't have been singing about knowing a change is going to come if it was not a long time coming.

[00:51:45] Where was the love? My eight grandparents were born in the early 1900s when thousands of black folks were being lynched. Race riots was on the rise, such as the Atlanta race riot in 1906, Springfield in 1908, East St. Louis in 1917, the Red Summer in Chicago and Omaha in 1919, the Sherman riot in 1930.

[00:52:06] Mr. Speaker, singer-songwriter and activist Nina Simone, would have not sung of southern trees bearing strange fruit if black bodies were not swinging in the southern breeze. There was legalized discrimination in housing, education, transportation, health care, and voting.

[00:52:25] Most black people from that time never saw someone that looked like them in their state or federal office here in the Commonwealth. From 1891 to 1971, the political blackout was successful. Where was the humanity?

[00:52:42] Now I could talk about my 16 great-great-grandparents, Mr. Speaker, but history tells us the 1800s was not a great time for black people outside of the short-lived Reconstruction era. Mr. Speaker, now that we went down that history lane, and I believe that no one in this current body was voting on bills back then, I believe.

[00:53:02] Now, from my perspective of the history that I just gave, I would hope folks understand when they hear the words, make America great again. Some of us want to know what time frame exactly are we speaking of?

[00:53:19] Mr. Speaker, this speech is not meant to point blame. It's not meant to shame. It's not meant to make black people victims. It's meant to make folks aware of truths. It's meant to remind us through many dangerous tours and snares that we have been unassailable.

[00:53:36] To see the strides made here in the General Assembly and the ones back in the 84th District in Suffolk, where we have our first black constitutional officer, our Commonwealth Attorney Narendra Plez, and also our first black woman on the city council, Ms. Ebony Wright.

[00:53:53] In closing, let us remember these painful truths of the past. Not to invoke anger, fear, sadness, or judgment, but as the truths they are, and let us legislate with some compassion and love to undo the wrongs of the past, to stand up against all forms of hate, and to fight for the equity we need now.

[00:54:18] Mr. Speaker and members of the House, with love, happy Black History Month. DELEGATE TATO: The Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Tater.

[00:54:37] DELEGATE TATO: Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a point of personal privilege. DELEGATE TATO: Delegate, that's the floor. DELEGATE TATO: Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, like many Virginians, I tuned in to both the President's State of the Union address and Governor Spanberger's response last night. I appreciate a healthy policy debate and exchange of ideas.

[00:54:57] While I disagree with much of what our governor stated, I do believe that she pointed to three vital questions that millions of Virginians are asking of her administration. What are you doing to make things more affordable? What are you doing to make us safer? And what are you doing to work for us?

[00:55:13] Mr. Speaker, I would ask Governor Spanberger, what is she doing to make life more affordable in Virginia? She asked about affordability, yet her party has done nothing to lower costs. We proposed over

a dozen bills to offer immediate relief, my bill to eliminate local grocery tax, and others to end taxes on personal vehicles, overtime, and tips.

[00:55:35] We offered bills to provide tax credits for small businesses, first-time homebuyers, and families with children. Every single one was killed in committee on a party-line vote. Instead, the majority prioritized a new payroll tax on workers for mandated paid family leave in a collective bargaining package projected to cost localities $400 million.

[00:55:56] Mr. Speaker, this isn't affordability. This is a pay cut for every hard-working Virginian. Mr. Speaker, I would ask Governor Spanberger, what is she doing to make things safer for Virginians? One of her first actions was to issue an executive order to terminate agreements between Virginia law enforcement and federal immigration enforcement to assist in apprehending criminal illegal aliens, like the man from El Salvador who was arrested for shooting and killing a man in Reston.

[00:56:25] He had been released from the Fairfax County Jail just one day prior. This was after prosecutors dropped the previous charges despite an active ICE detainer. or another illegal immigrant from El Salvador who was charged with the murder and strangulation of an 8-year-old girl in Leesburg.

[00:56:42] This man had been released from prior charge before ICE could apprehend him. Mr. Speaker, this policy puts innocent Virginians in danger. While the majority in this body moves to disarm law-abiding citizens in total disregard to the Second Amendment, They simultaneously pushed soft-on-crimes policies to eliminate mandatory minimums for some of the most heinous crimes like murder and rape.

[00:57:09] Mr. Speaker, you can't make Virginia safer by protecting predators and disarming victims. And Mr. Speaker, I would finally ask Governor Spanberger, what is she doing to work for us? She spoke about our storied history as a nation and how our forefathers stood up and demanded more of their leaders.

[00:57:25] Today, Virginians demand more of their governor. They want a governor who is a woman of her word, a governor who remembers she was a vocal supporter of the 2020 constitutional amendment to put redistricting in the hands of a bipartisan commission, a governor who stays true to her promise, a promise made just last August where she would not pursue redistricting and gerrymandering in Virginia.

[00:57:51] Last night, the governor boasted that her party is stepping up to run in 2026. Well, Mr. Speaker, it's easy to step up when you've already handpicked your own voters through gerrymandering. Virginia deserves a leader who keeps her word and stands for fairness.

[00:58:08] Mr. Speaker, I hope Governor Spanberger will rise above the political fray to uphold the Virginia standard of honesty and fairness. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan.

[00:58:31] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I ask we return to the first morning hour for purpose of an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, joining us in the gallery are some students with an organization called Virginia 21. Could they please stand up? I think they're up there. There they are right over me.

[00:58:47] Mr. Speaker, Virginia 21 is a statewide, nonpartisan organization that equips college students to engage thoughtfully and effectively in the civic life of our commonwealth. Today we have up there 40 students from 19 institutions, including public, private, and community colleges.

[00:59:04] These students are not here just as spectators, though, Mr. Speaker. They are here as advocates, informed, prepared, and committed to strengthening Virginia's future. They bring with them the voices, experiences, and priorities of their peers. Through Virginia 21, they are learning how policy is shaped, how institutions function, and how to lead with both conviction and respect.

[00:59:24] Their presence here today, Mr. Speaker, is a reminder that the next generation of Virginia's leaders is already stepping forward. I hope the body will join me in giving them a warm house welcome.

[00:59:44] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The delegate from Norfolk, Doug Glass. Gratitude, Mr. Speaker, I rise for a point of personal privilege. The delegate has the floor. Gratitude, Mr. Speaker. If everybody in this country made decisions the way that you do, would America collapse or would it evolve?

[01:00:11] It's an internal question I ask myself. If every judge interpreted the law the way that you do, if every pastor interpreted the scripture the way that you do, If every legislator exercised power the way that you do, would the collective we, the people, expand or would we shrink to a selective we, the people?

[01:00:38] I ask this and I ask it of myself all the time, Mr. Speaker, because interpretation matters. It is the difference between perception and perspective. I remember maybe it was two or three years ago.

[01:00:58] It had to be more than that, COVID. maybe five years ago, I called my late grandmother, of course, after the view. And I ended up talking to her for some odd reason about unicorns. And she stopped me mid-sentence, Mr. Speaker, and she said, now, child, you know that's in the Bible. And I said, nah, grandma, unicorns isn't in the Bible. And she said, yeah, child, and stuff it is. Now, she used to keep this little mustard bottle by her on the table um one of the old school ones that were like circular and i she

[01:01:38] put in there her hot water she would call it hot water that was her liquor y'all um and i was thinking like grandma done had too much hot water um but i know she'd never over overindulge in everything except for her word with a capital w so she did she gave me that good old copd cough and she said go to Job 39 and 9 and I'm sitting there thinking I'm about to google this because there ain't no way that unicorns are in the bible and there was she said that ain't the only place

[01:02:12] either my grandmother used the King James version of the bible and that translation translation had unicorn in it numbers also mentions it now modern scholars Mr. Speaker their version replace it They place it with the Hebrew word or they replace it with the word wild ox.

[01:02:34] But here's the thing about that, is that with that one edit, it sort of changes the translation of what the sentence means to the mind's eye. Putting that together to what's happening in this time.

[01:02:51] Sometimes, Mr. Speaker, oppression doesn't show up as a whip. It shows up as an interpretation. For clarity, there is also a passage in Genesis where Noah's son Ham, okay, Noah got drunk. i'm just gonna preface this he was naked in the vineyard vineyard ham saw him when he told his brothers his dad was like you're disrespectful and i'm gonna curse your child right he said your son's gonna be a servant of servants that text itself did not mention race but in american

[01:03:26] history that story was twisted and became what is known as the curse of ham doctrine a claim that African people were divinely destined for slavery. That theology was preached from pulpits to justify bondage.

[01:03:47] And that blows my mind, Mr. Speaker. At the same time, those same enslaved Africans who were forced into Christianity read the same book and found Exodus. Let my people go.

[01:04:04] They found prophets condemning injustice, Mr. Speaker. They found that all people were made in the image of God. Same text, different interpretation. Mr. Speaker, I am not here to disrespect anybody's faith.

[01:04:21] I grew up in it. I value it. But we all have to tell the truth about human behavior. God doesn't need editing. We do. And whenever people handle sacred texts, there's a risk. We start translating our discomfort instead of translating the text.

[01:04:41] We start sanding down what is wild so that it can fit into our pockets. And sometimes, Mr. Speaker, interpretation, it's guided by humanity, and sometimes it's guided by convenience. Sometimes it's guided by consciousness, and sometimes it's guided by agenda.

[01:05:02] America has two civic scriptures, Mr. Speaker. We got the Bible, and we got that Constitution. Both are quoted in this chamber. Both invoked to justify power. both treated as sacred both have been used to discipline black bodies that is the american way our civic scripture the constitution at its founding mr speaker it contained compromises with enslavement the first amendment mr speaker it promised freedom of speech and yet it was a

[01:05:39] crime for our ancestor to even speak the word freedom but here's what also belongs to our history black americans have never abandoned the constitution we insisted that it applied with the promise of speech association and petition we petitioned under the first amendment in virginia black families use the first amendment through the nl through the naacp to get together to say

[01:06:13] d we need to desegregate with the promise of due process and equal protection those same folks we went ahead and litigated under the 14th Amendment. And when the Commonwealth even tried to choke off that ability by here in Virginia, in this body, creating the Virginia Code, Chapter 33, saying NAACP, y'all ain't got no right. The courts of Virginia said, no, y'all ain't got no right.

[01:06:42] The Supreme Court of Virginia said, no. It took the United States Supreme Court to say, you do. WACP versus Budden. With the promise of freedom, Mr. Speaker, we pushed for the 13th Amendment to mean something in real life. But that loophole said, accept as punishment for a crime. We were free and nay and re-enslaved through policy. The promise of voting rights, regardless of your race,

[01:07:14] was made, but met with poll taxes, literacy tests, grandfather clauses, wipe-only primaries, terrorism by the KKK. We demanded enforcement. We have worked through these mechanisms that the framers left behind, Mr. Speaker. The founding fathers were not perfect men, but they wrote these soaring words about liberty while tolerating bondage. That contradiction

[01:07:51] is a part of our inheritance. But they also did something profoundly wise. They did not write a frozen document. They built amendability, Article 5, right? It outlines the amendment process, a pathway for correction, a mechanism for redress. They understood they were not final.

[01:08:15] The Constitution was incomplete at birth. It was not closed. And because it was not closed, generation of Americans, especially black Americans, labored inside that space, not tearing it down but calling it into itself today working on the constitution to me it feels so naive it feels like naivete for somebody like me to say that but my mature mind knows mr speaker

[01:08:49] that it is covenant work that and that every time my folks did that covenant work every time it was exercise resistance was built and in building architecture can be renovated which brings me back to

interpretation. Mr. Speaker, whiteness was expanded when it was politically convenient, while blackness has remained a fixed line. Now, here is part that, I think this is a part that

[01:09:29] we don't always say out loud. When black folks were reaching for that promise, not only did America build these barriers, they've started recruiting. You see, whiteness at the time, and still it's not just an identity in american history history whiteness functioned as a kind of membership and i want to tread very carefully here i am not talking about individual hearts mr speaker i am talking about structures over time the legal and social boundaries of belonging

[01:10:08] in this country shifted groups excluded from whiteness were gradually incorporated into it And again, this is not any accusation. This is about structural observation. During the peak of Irish immigration in the mid-19th century, Irish Catholics faced immense discrimination from the Protestant folks.

[01:10:33] They were caricatured as ape-like, violent, unfit for self-governing. Some newspapers and political cartoons placed them socially along the side of black folks. But over time, that boundary shifted and Irish-Americans were folded into whiteness.

[01:10:52] That line moved, but again, blackness did not move. And although they were legally classified for naturalization purposes, even the Italians, specifically the southern Italians, faced intense racial discrimination and weren't even considered socially white until the 19th and 20th century.

[01:11:14] Citizenship laws, court cases, who counted them as white to expand political suffrage while restricting black folks. These things are documented in our history. Boundaries move.

[01:11:32] And I'm not saying to anybody listening to our conversation right now, Mr. Speaker, I'm not saying they wrote those laws. What I'm saying again is that we inherit a system where they existed, and we have a choice. Pretend it's real, pretend that it's not real, or stop it from repeating.

[01:11:51] So let me come back to that question, Mr. Speaker. If everybody interpreted power the way that black Americans have in history, would we collapse or would we evolve?

[01:12:07] I'll close by saying this. Right before I was supposed to be leaving to come to session, I was standing in that same kitchen I was pacing in with my grandma telling me about them daggum unicorns in the Bible. I had my clothes laying all over the kitchen because I couldn't get myself to get in the car to come down here to start session.

[01:12:29] I thought if I just changed my environment, then maybe I'd get to it. I think my daughter could see the weight that was on me with trying to mentally prepare. And she just looked at me and said, Ma, get up the road. She did not give me the sympathy that I was expecting.

[01:12:45] So I called my spouse and I said, you know, I'm stuck and I just can't get out the door. And he said to me, Jack, do you know who you are?

[01:13:04] I said, uh, I am tired, I am anxious, and I am sad to be leaving. He said, no, no, no, no. I want you to hear this. You can be right or you can be safe, but you cannot be both.

[01:13:19] You are a unicorn, and unicorns are hunted. The sooner you get comfortable, the better you go move, not get up the road. Black Americans have lived as unicorns inside these two covenants, hunted.

[01:13:38] revised, misinterpreted, and still believing, still serving, still voting, still litigating, still amending, still calling America into itself. Black folks, stubborn, praying, taxpaying black folks, keep reading them like the promise applied to them. Mr. Speaker, we were denied literacy, yet we memorized scripture. We were denied citizenship,

[01:14:11] yet we fought wars we were denied to vote yet we organized democracy and if the belief in the constitution means demanding that it lives up to its own words or the scripture was written not to oppress then black americans are the truest of believers black history is not a guilt trip mr speaker it is a field manual it teaches us it costs to insist that the promise is real now i'm ask for your permission for something, Mr. Speaker, because I know when we're doing this,

[01:14:46] we're supposed to speak to the speaker. I'm asking permission to speak to the body. See? Oh no. Okay. If you are in this chamber and you are trying to do the right thing in a hard time, if you are trying to expand the participation instead of restricted, if you are trying to interpret our founding documents toward inclusion instead of fear, you too may feel hunted. That discomfort

[01:15:21] is not danger. It means that you are simply untamable. We can be the kind of Americans who get defensive about history, or we can be the kind of Americans who get responsible with it.

[01:15:39] Gratitude, Mr. Speaker. Clerk will call the calendar. Calendar for today for the Virginia House of Delegates this Wednesday, February 25th. First category, Senate Bill's on third, reading uncontested, uncontested calendar. Senate Bill 3 on page one and Senate Bill 88 are out of the block therefore the first bill on page 2 within this Senate

[01:16:15] reading third Senate bills third reading I can discounter Senate bill 127 as legislation mentoring acts at portions of the acts of assembly 1942 which provided a charter for the town of Chatham in Pennsylvania County relating to town powers in town council legislation report committee on county cities and towns Mr. Speaker the delegate from Fairfax Delegate Helmer. Thank you Mr. Speaker Mr. Speaker this is the cognate of House Bill 1050 by Phillips which passed the House on February 17th on a vote of 97 to 0. I move passage of the bill. Senate Bill 134 and 140 and printed calendar are out of the block. So next up in the block is Senate Bill 149,

[01:16:54] which seeks to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia relating to state's facilitated IRA savings program. Legislation report committee on appropriation. Delicator from Prince William, delegatorian. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Senate Bill 149 is identical to my House Bill 176, which passes House. This bill makes certain technical changes and broadens eligibility requirements for RetirePath, the state-facilitated retirement savings program administered by the Commonwealth Savers Plan. Senate Bill 149 will expand RetirePath eligibility and access to more than 350,000 Virginians. It allows them a way to save for their retirement and as no additional cost to the Commonwealth or

[01:17:33] our business community must speak, I move passes of the bill. Continuing with the Calendar Senate Bill 167 is next up in this uncontested calendar blog. It seeks to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia relating to public institutions of higher education, financial aid review and consolidation, Virginia Guaranteed Assistance Program and fund, Virginia Commonwealth Award established.

[01:17:53] Legislation Board Committee on Appropriations with Amendment Nature Substitute. Delegate for President Williams, Delegate Sewell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt

the Appropriations Committee Substitute. Shall the Committee Substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The Committee Substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:18:08] The substitute conforms the bill to My House Bill 1221, which passed the body. The bill consolidates various financial aid programs and establishes the Virginia Commonwealth Grant Award and a work group to make recommendations to maximize the efficacy and impact of state aid.

[01:18:26] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill passes. Senate Bill 281 seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Acts of Assembly of 1926 to provide a charter for the town of Waverly in Sussex County and to repeal a portion thereof all relating to elections, town council, mayor, town manager, and town powers.

[01:18:42] The legislature has an emergency clause. It was reported for the committee on county, cities, and towns. Delegate from Fairfax. Delegate Helm. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this bill simply amends the charter of the town of Waverly. As the clerk described, it moves the council elections from May to November and transfers them from a strong mayor form of government to a council manager form of government.

[01:19:01] I move passage of the bill. Senate Bill 286, top of page 5. Print the calendar is out of the block. Therefore, next up in the block, Senate Bill 289, which seeks to amend and reenact portion of the Acts of the Assembly of 1950, which provided a charter for the city of Hopewell relating to the Hopewell Water Renewal Commission. So let's say this report's beginning on county, cities, and towns.

[01:19:19] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Senate Bill 289 by Senator Aird updates the charter of the city of Hopewell Water Renewal Commission. It changes the membership makeup of the Hopewell Water Renewal Commission. I hope it is the will of the body to pass the bill. Senate Bill 303, now before you, seeks to amend and reenact portion of the Act of the Assembly of 1973, which provided a charter for the City of Suffolk, relating to council composition, city clerk, department oversight.

[01:19:44] Again, legislate reporting on counties, cities, and towns. Delegate from Suffolk, Delegate Clark. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I move that we pass this bill by for the day. Without objection, SB 303 is by for the day. Next up in the uncontested block is Senate Bill 329. It is legislation to amend and reenact portion of the Code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Sexual and Domestic Violence Victim Fund.

[01:20:04] Additional fee for certain offenses. Legislation reporting on public safety with an amendment in the nature of substitute. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I just want to be clear, the board does say SB 303, I believe this clerk introduced.

[01:20:20] I want to make sure I'm speaking on Senate Bill 329, thank you. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. So this bill raises a fee imposed on convicted traffickers and solicitors from $100 to $500. This is now going to be identical to what I will accept in the Senate for my House Bill 1223, which will be conformed.

[01:20:42] We will also make sure that we clarify that these funds will go to the Virginia Sexual and Domestic Violence Fund, and then we will clarify that that fund both supports human trafficking and domestic violence victims. And it's my hope that this body will engross the bill and move it to final passage.

[01:20:59] And do the substitute. Did you move the substitute? Oh, Mr. Speaker, do I move the substitute? Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Next up in the block, Senate Bill 343, legislation meant reenact a portion of the Acts of the Assembly of 1968, which provided a charter for the town of Herndon in Fairfax County, repealing other portions of the same, relating to the town manager, town employees, town attorney, legislation reported from the committee for county, cities, and towns.

[01:21:31] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This Senate Bill 343 is identical to House Bill 887, which passed the House 97-0 on February 5th. Senate Bill 343 amends the charter for the town of Herndon at the request of their town council. And, Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be passed.

[01:21:47] Next up in the block, Senate Bill 385 is a legislation amended and reenacted a portion of the Acts of the Assembly of 1937, which provided a charter for the town of Front Row in Warren County, relating to the town manager. Again, the legislature report on county cities and towns. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon.

[01:22:03] Mr. Speaker, I move that Senate Bill 385 go by for the day. The delegate moves that Senate Bill 385 go by for the day. All in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's by for the day. Senate Bill 403 is out of the block, so therefore, over on page 8, we continue with this uncontested calendar block. We come to Senate Bill 404, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to active pharmaceutical ingredient manufacturing grant fund legislation was reported to the Committee on Appropriations.

[01:22:26] Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Tory. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Senate Bill 404 is identical to my House Bill 800, which passed this House. This bill codifies the MEI Commission-approved economic development project for Eli Lilly to produce active pharmaceutical ingredients in Goochland County.

[01:22:44] The company will create 468 jobs and invest $2.1 billion in Goochland County. Mr. Speaker, I move past this other bill. Senate Bill 439. Now, before you seek to amend it, we enact two portions of the Code of Virginia Related to the Department of Education, College and Career Ready Virginia Program, Administration, Advisory Committee, and Work Group Composition.

[01:23:05] Legislation, again, reported committing on appropriations. Delegate from Richmond, Delegate Carr. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 439 is identical to my HB 1039, which simply removes the Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond from the Career and College Ready Virginia Advisory Group.

[01:23:22] I move the bill's passage. Next up in the block, Senate Bill 462 repeals a portion of the Act of Assembly of 1972 and provides a new charter for the town of Louisa County, town of Louisa in Louisa County. This legislation was reported from the Committee on County, Cities, and Towns.

[01:23:40] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, I move that Senate Bill 462 go by for the day. The delegate from Fairfax, I move that Senate Bill 462 go by for the day. As many favors, I motion to say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. SB 462 is by for the day. Next up in the block, Senate Bill 599 is legislation that seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Opioid Use, Reduction, and Jail-Based Substance Use Disorder Treatment and Transition Fund grant procedures.

[01:24:03] Legislation reporting on public safety. Delegate from Henrico, Delegate Willett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, SB 599 is identical to my HB 455, requires the grant procedure governing funds

awarded to local and regional jails for substance use disorder treatment and reentry services, set grant terms of up to three years.

[01:24:21] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Next up in the block, Senate Bill 744 seeks to amend and reenact section of the Code of Virginia relating to the Public Recreational Facilities Authorities Act. Legislation reporting on county, cities, and towns. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Senate Bill 744 is the Public Recreational Facilities Authorities Act.

[01:24:41] It authorizes authorities established under the Public Recreational Facilities Authorities Act to make grants to any participating locality, the Commonwealth, or any other political subdivision agency or instrumentality thereof. I hope I move passage of the bill. Shall the bills pass? Clerk will close the row.

[01:25:10] Ayes 97, noes 0. Ayes 97, noes 0. The bill, bills pass. Continuing with today's calendar over on page 10, the printed version, if you're following on that way, new category, Senate bills on third reading or final passage, regular calendar.

[01:25:26] We begin with Senate Bill 10, which is legislation to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia related to employment prohibition exceptions, apprenticeship, children 16 years of age or older. Legislation reported a committee on labor and commerce with amendment nature substitute. The delegate from Roanoke, Delegate Rasul.

[01:25:42] Mr. Speaker, I move that this bill go by for the day. Delegate from Roanoke moves to Senate Bill 10 go by for the day. As many in favor, the motion to say aye? Aye. Those opposed, no. Senate Bill 10 is by for the day. Senate Bill 513 now before you. Seeks to amend and reenact Portia Dakota, Virginia relating to comprehensive crisis system, Marcus Alert system, powers and duties of the Department of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services related to comprehensive mental health, Substance Abuse and Developmental Disabilities, Crisis Services, Written Plan, Legislation Report, Committee on Health and Human Services.

[01:26:10] The Delegate from Eriko, Delegate Willett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, SB 513 is identical to my HB 453, authorized the Department of Behavioral, Health and Developmental Services, in collaboration with the Department of Criminal Justice Services, to amend the crisis system plans. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass.

[01:26:29] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 98, no zero. Ayes 98, no zero.

[01:26:44] The bill passes. Over on page 11, we come to Senate Bill 514, Legislation Amendment and Reenaction, Portion of Dakota, Virginia, related to Marcus Alert Evaluation Task Force Creation, Legislation Reporting Committee on Health and Human Services. Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Hope.

[01:27:02] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 514 is identical to my House Bill 225, which passed this body on February the 9th, 98 to 0. It requires the Department of Behavioral Health to convene a Marcus Alert Evaluation Task Force to determine the effectiveness of Marcus Alert.

[01:27:18] This was a recommendation of the Behavioral Health Commission. I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:27:33] Ayes, 96, noes, 0. Ayes, 96, noes, 0. The bill passes. Senate Bill 520, now before you, seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia relating to Uninsured Employers Fund Administrative

Expenses, Legislation Report Committee on Labor and Commerce. Delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward.

[01:27:50] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Senate Bill 520 is identical to the bill that I passed, 572, which passes House 99 to 0. It deals with the Uninsured Employers Fund, and it provides that the cost of administering this fund would be paid for or administered by the Virginia Workers' Compensation.

[01:28:11] I move passage of the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:28:28] Ayes 97, no zero. Ayes 97, no zero. The bill passes. Ms. Speaker, Members of the House, next up is Senate Bill 669, Legislation seeks to amend and reenact four sections of the Code of Virginia related to pharmacy benefits managers, requirements, application of law, report.

[01:28:52] Legislation will report the committee on labor and commerce with the substitute. And, Ms. Speaker, there is a floor substitute offered by Delegate Coulson. Delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Coulson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House adopt the Senate labor and commerce substitute, but ask my colleagues to vote no.

[01:29:11] Shall the committee substitute be agreed to all those in favor say aye? Those opposed, no. Committee substitute is rejected. The delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Carlson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House adopt the floor substitute and speaking briefly to that substitute. The delegate has the floor. So this bill is a PBM reform and accountability bill. It excludes Medicaid.

[01:29:28] I'm sorry. One moment. Chuck will report that substitute and make sure it's available on IHOT. So, substitute for Senate bill by Delegate Carlson to Senate Bill 669 is available to the members here electronically via IHOT and is available to the public externally via the legislative information system.

[01:29:44] system. Then from Albemarle, Delegate Council. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. It's a reform and accountability, PBM reform and accountability bill. It excludes Medicaid along with other exemptions. The floor substitute is a catch by appropriation staff that for consistency and out of an abundance of caution, we make clear that that exemption also includes CHIP. Otherwise, the bill is in substantially the same posture as my cognate, House Bill 830, which passed this House unanimously. Mr. Speaker, I move the substitute and then I move that the bill pass. Shall the floor substitute be agreed to. All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The floor

[01:30:17] substitute is agreed to. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 98, noes 0. Ayes 98, noes 0. The bill passes. Over on page 12, we come to Senate Bill 26, legislation to amend the Code of Virginia related to land development, solar canopies, and surface parking areas. Legislation reported committee on counties, cities, and towns.

[01:30:52] And there is a floor amendment offered by Delegate Sewell in gross version. Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Sewell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:31:08] Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the floor substitute, and I would like to explain it. The floor amendments are available to the public and to the members electronically, so they're now before you. Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Sewell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The amendment contains clarifying language from the Virginia Department of Environmental Quality on impervious surfaces. Both the parking lot and a solar panel could technically count as an impervious surface. We wanted to clarify that. Mr. Speaker, with the substitute SB 26, like my bill, HB 1234, gives localities the authority to decide

for themselves based on their own climate, energy, and land use goals, whether solar parking canopies make sense.

[01:31:47] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. The delegate from Buckingham, Delegate Garrett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I speak in favor of the bill. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I want to caution my colleagues against immediately, and I apologize, I got to choose my words wisely, just because it has the word solar in it doesn't mean it's bad.

[01:32:07] And what this does is it lets localities do a particular thing, and I think I can guess which localities might do that particular thing, and that particular thing might make it more expensive to open a business in those localities. but we could use the jobs and those businesses, et cetera, in our localities.

[01:32:23] So I think that this bill is one where we arrive at the exact same place, perhaps for different reasons, but I'm going to vote for it like I did my colleagues from Prince William County. And I would ask that you all do. I think that, again, this might benefit some people in some ways and other people in other ways, but I think it's not bad policy.

[01:32:39] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the floor amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The floor amendment is agreed to. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:33:01] Ayes. 75, noes 21. Ayes 75, noes 21. The bill passes. Next up is Senate Bill 44, legislation to amend and reenact a section of the Code of Virginia relating to registration by localities of cemeteries on private property. Planning District 8. Legislation reporting on county, cities, and towns with an amendment.

[01:33:19] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Hellman. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 44 by Delegate Rome deals with the registration by localities of cemeteries on private property in Planning District 8. It requires localities in Planning District 8 to adopt an ordinance setting forth a register of identified cemeteries, graveyards, or other places of burial.

[01:33:36] The bill, with the committee amendment, which I'll move in a second, has a reenactment clause. I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Committee amendment is agreed to. I move passage of the bill. Shall the bill pass?

[01:34:03] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 78, noes 20. Ayes 78, noes 20. The bill passes. Senate Bill 57 would require the Commonwealth's participation in the Electronic Registration Information Center, or ERIC, legislation reported on privileges and elections.

[01:34:19] Senator from Newport News, Delegate Price. Thank you. Senate Bill 57 is identical to parts of House Bill 215 that would require the Commissioner of Elections to apply for, enter, into, and maintain membership for the Commonwealth in the Electronic Registration Information Center, known as ERIC.

[01:34:35] The House bill passed 62 to 35, and I move that we pass the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:34:53] Ayes, 64, noes, 34. Ayes, 64, noes, 34. The bill passes. Next up is Senate Bill 58. Legislation to amend and reenact three sections of the Code of Virginia relating to elections. Deadline for receipt of absentee ballots and certain other information, 5 p.m. on the third day after the election.

[01:35:11] Legislation to report a committee on privileges in elections. And, Mr. Speaker, members of the House, the Delegate Price has floor amendments that are available to the members here and online as well through the public. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I move that we adopt the floor amendments, and I'd like to speak to that motion.

[01:35:30] Delegate has the floor. Thank you. This amendment adds a delayed enactment clause of January 1, 2027. Shall the floor amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The floor amendment is agreed to. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Thank you. Now, Senate Bill 58 is now identical to House Bill 82 and moves the deadline for receipt of an absentee ballot.

[01:35:50] Information required to cure an absentee ballot and proof of identification to accompany a provisional ballot provided for lack of identification from noon to 5 p.m. on the third day after the election. This bill passed 60 to 35, and I would move that we pass the bill.

[01:36:07] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 64, no's 34. Ayes, 64, no's 34.

[01:36:22] the bill passes. Senate Bill 60 now before you seeks to amend and reenact various portions of the Code of Virginia, all relating to the Virginia Parole Board, powers and duties, juvenile offenders, parole procedures, and considerations. Legislation reporting on public safety with an amendment nature substitute. Senator from Arlington, Delegate Hope. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 60 has a substitute which would bring it in line with my House Bill 318, so I would move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye.

[01:36:52] All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. The delegate from Arlington. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 60 is now the cognate of my Bill 318, which passed here on February 17th by a vote of 67 to 29. It makes various reforms to the parole board. For one thing, it expands the number of parole members from 5 to 11.

[01:37:11] It depoliticizes the board with staggered terms to make sure there's no real meaningful change there from year to year. and it establishes juveniles have a meaningful opportunity for release, according to the United States Supreme Court. I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass?

[01:37:34] Close the roll. Ayes, 69, nos, 29. Ayes, 69, nos, 29. The bill passes. Over on page 14, we come to Senate Bill 94.

[01:37:49] Legislation amend the code of Virginia relating to siting of data centers, site assessment, high-energy use facility. Legislation reporting from counties, cities, and towns with the amendment nature of substitute. Then from Prince William, Delegate Thomas. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute bill agree to? All those in favor, say aye.

[01:38:05] All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 94 is now identical to my House Bill 153, which passed this body in a vote of 90 to 7 and merely puts guardrails on high energy use facilities such as data centers. I move passage of the bill.

[01:38:21] Shall the bill pass?

[01:38:40] House of Bities.

[01:40:35] The House will come to order.

[01:41:51] Shall the bill pass?

[01:42:04] Close the roll. Ayes 80, nos 14. Ayes 80, nos 14. the bill passes. Senate Bill 123 is not before you. So next up, Senate Bill's third reading regular is Senate Bill 160. Legislation amendment reenact two sections go to Virginia relating to purchase, possession, or transportation of a firearm, salt and battery of a family or household member or intimate partner penalty. Legislation reporting on public safety with amendment nature substitute. Delegate McClure. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, SB 160 is the cognate to my HB19, which will close the deadly dating partner loophole in our code for convicted

[01:42:39] domestic abusers. Mr. Speaker, I ask that we move the committee substitute with the recommendation that we accept it. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to deduct from all of the deductible clause. Yes, Mr. Speaker.

[01:42:55] So as amended, it actually moves some commas around. So that is the substitute. And I renew my motion. I actually ask that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 64.

[01:43:16] Ayes 64, noes 34. Ayes 64, noes 34. The bill passed. House bill, excuse me, Senate bill, Senate bill 162, top of page 15. Now before you, seeks to amend and reenact various portions of the Code of Virginia or Lane to vote a registration, restoration of political rights upon release from incarceration, certain adjudications, legislation reporting on privileges and elections with an amendment nature substitute.

[01:43:37] Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All of the polls know the committee substitutes agree to the delegate for Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, thank you. Senate Bill 162 is now substantively identical to my House Bill 964 that passed the House 63 to 34.

[01:43:56] This bill is the enabling legislation for the voting rights proposed constitutional amendment and would only go into effect should a majority of the voters vote yes on that amendment. I move that we pass the bill. Shall the bill pass?

[01:44:17] Clerk, close the bill. Ayes 65, nos 33. Ayes 65, nos 33. The bill passes. Next up, Senate Bill 176, seeks to amend or reenact a portion of the Acts of Assembly of 2020 relating to elections, conduct of election, ranked choice voting, locally elected offices report.

[01:44:35] Legislation report depending on privileges at elections. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 176 is identical to House Bill 630, which passed the House 62 to 34, and establishes guardrails and outlines how elections with ranked choice voting are to be run and tabulated in localities that choose to use it for local elections.

[01:44:56] It also includes mandates for voter education and outreach about ranked choice voting, should it be chosen. I move that we pass the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the vote.

[01:45:14] Ayes. 64, noes. 34. Ayes. 64, noes. 34, the bill passes. Over on page 16, Bill, before you next is Senate Bill 226. Legislation amend the Code of Virginia related to local competitive bidding for compost and other products containing organic soil amendments, waste disposal, infrastructure, civil penalty.

[01:45:34] Legislation report committing on county, cities, and towns with an amendment in the nature of a substitute. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Senate Bill 226, page 16. Thank you. Sorry, this one was confusing.

[01:45:51] Move the substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Substitute is agreed to. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helm. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. With the substitute in front of us, this is now the cognate of the House bill by Delegate Tran, which passed the House on February 5th on a vote of 65 to 28, and I move passage of the bill.

[01:46:14] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 66, noes, 32. Ayes, 66, noes, 32.

[01:46:31] The bill passes. Senate Bill 311 would provide for the submission of the voters of a proposed amendment to Section 15A of Article 1 of the Constitution relating to marriage between two adult persons, repeal of same-sex marriage, prohibition, legislation reporting, committing on privileges and elections. Senator from Newport News, Delegate Price.

[01:46:46] Thank you. Senate Bill 311 is identical to House Bill 612, which passed 66 to 32, and is the voter referendum bill for the referendum at the November general election, the proposed constitutional amendment, which repeals the current provision that defines marriage as only a union between one man and one woman and requires marriage equality between two adult persons. I move the bill pass.

[01:47:11] Shall the bill pass? The clerk will close the room. Ayes, 66, noes, 31.

[01:47:28] Ayes, 66, noes, 31. The bill passes. Senate Bill 314, now before you, seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to tourism improvement districts administering nonprofits. Legislation will support a community on county, cities, and towns. That is from Arlington, Delegate McClure. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:47:44] Mr. Speaker, SB 314 is the cognate to my HB 524, which passed this body with bipartisan support and would allow my home county of Arlington County to adopt a tourism improvement district to increase its resources and capacity for tourism promotion. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass?

[01:48:05] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 67, noes 30. Ayes 67, noes 30. The bill passes. Senate Bill 322 seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia, portions of the Code of Virginia, relating to presidential electors and the agreement among the states to elect the president by national popular vote compact.

[01:48:27] Legislation and support committee on privileges and elections. The delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 322 is identical to my House Bill 965, which passed 61 to 36 and would enter Virginia into an interstate compact known as the Agreement Among the States to elect the president by national popular vote.

[01:48:52] I move that the bill passed. The delegate from Spotsylvania, Delegate Scott. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the bill. Duncan has the floor. Mr. Speaker, history has a tendency to repeat itself. This is not the first time this piece of legislation has gone through this chamber. It happened in 2021. The only difference was the Senate didn't allow it to go through. So my question is, who's too terrified of Trump? You see, in 2024, Trump won the popular vote. He didn't win Virginia. But in 2024, that would have meant that Trump's electoral college vote or the electoral college votes for Virginia would have gone to Trump. So I have to ask, was the administration pressuring the other

[01:49:31] side to carry this piece of legislation? Maybe you're just too terrified of Trump to stop something like this from going through. You see what this bill does is it disenfranchises voters. It seems to

be the pattern of the other side. This session is disenfranchisement of voters, because what what happened is if the Virginia voters voted for Spanberger, but the national popular vote goes for the Republican candidate, then the Virginia electoral votes would go towards the Republican candidate. Mr. Speaker, I was very much opposed to this before in 2021, and I wrote

[01:50:06] Governor Northam saying that this was not good legislation. The way the electoral college vote system works is that it represents the voters of each state. And so I believe that if our voters here in Virginia, support a specific candidate. That's how the Electoral College votes should go. It shouldn't go with the rest of the nation does. We should do what our voters call on us to do. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:50:29] Shall the bill pass? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 62, noes. 36.

[01:50:44] Ayes. 62, noes. 36. The bill passes. Over on page 18, we come to Senate Bill 324. Legislation amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia related to the Virginia Public Procurement Act. Additional public works contract requirements report. Legislation reporting on appropriations with an amendment nature substitute.

[01:51:08] Delegate from Prince William. Oh, I'm sorry. You didn't hit the button. My bad. The delegate from Richmond City. Delegate Carr. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you. As amended, Senate Bill 324 is identical to my HB 1046, which passed this chamber. The bill requires contractors on public works to not be in violation of important federal labor laws and increases transparency on the use of independent contractors.

[01:51:43] The bill is delayed a year, allowing the Department of Labor and Industry and the Department of General Services to issue guidance on its implementation, and it creates a five-year evaluation on the feasibility of the apprenticeship requirements on public works. I move the bill's passage. Shall the bill pass?

[01:52:00] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 64, noes. 34. Ayes. 64, noes. 34. The bill passes. Senate Bill 348 seeks to amend and reenact a section of the Code of Virginia related to the storage of firearms in a residence where a minor or person prohibited from possessing a firearm is present.

[01:52:20] Penalty. Legislation report is pending on public safety. Dole from York County, Delegate Downey. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Senate Bill 348 is similar to my Bill HB 871, which passed the Chamber 60 to 37. The Senate Bill changes language that states the firearm may be stored loaded in a storage device with a combination lock, coded lock, or biometric lock.

[01:52:42] With that, I move that we pass the bill. The delegate from Campbell County, delegate, is there. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, responsible gun owners believe in safe storage. That's not controversial. But this bill goes beyond encouraging safety.

[01:52:58] It criminalizes parents for failing to meet a government-defined storage standard inside their own home. Here's the real problem. It creates a scenario where a teenager faced with a violent intruder may have to choose between defending their family or triggering a felony charge against their parents.

[01:53:15] It's not a theoretical tension. That's the structure of this bill. We should punish criminal misuse of firearms. But turning responsible parents into criminals because the government believes their storage method wasn't sufficient, that's a step too far.

[01:53:32] We don't strengthen families by threatening them with prison. I urge a no vote. Shall the bill pass? Kirk will close the row.

[01:53:48] Ayes, 62, nose, 35. I-62, Nose 35. The bill passes. Senate Bill 388. Now, before you cease to amend and reenact several sections of the Code of Virginia related to affordable housing, religious organizations, and other non-profit tax-exempt properties.

[01:54:04] Legislation Board Committee on counties, cities, and towns with amendments. Delegate from Fredericksburg, Delegate Cole. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee amendment is agreed to. Delegate from Fredericksburg, Delegate Cole. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. S.B. 388 is the cognate to my H.B. 1279. The bill allows religious institutions and nonprofit organizations to build affordable housing by right on land they already own.

[01:54:29] The amendments that we added in committee adds a reenactment clause to the bill, and I hope it would be the pleasure of the body to pass the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:54:49] Ayes 61, nos 37. Ayes 61, nos 37. The bill passes. Over on page 20, we come to Senate Bill 632. Legislation seeks to amend and reenact various sections of the Code of Virginia relating to elections. Candidate and elected officials address confidentiality.

[01:55:06] Legislation was reported from the committee on privileges of elections. And the chairman of House P&E, Delegate Price, has a floor amendment that is available to the public and to the members here. The delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:55:22] As the clerk said, I do have a floor amendment. The clerk has reported the floor amendment. Floor amendment offered by Delegate Price after line 195 of the gross insert that the provisions of this act shall become effective on January 1, 2027. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price.

[01:55:37] Thank you. As stated, the floor substitute adds a delayed enactment clause, so I would move that we would adopt the floor substitute. Shall the floor amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The floor amendment is agreed to. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price.

[01:55:52] Thank you. Senate Bill 632 is now identical to House Bill 835, which passed 79 to 19 and protects the home address of candidates and elected officials from public disclosure while preserving full verification authority from the Department of Elections.

[01:56:14] Residency requirements remain unchanged and courts and lawful investigations retain access. I move that we pass the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:56:32] Ayes. 82, noes 15. I have 82, no. 15, the bill passes. Senate Bill 648 is legislation to suspend certain officers, require a study, adopt a remedial plan, and establish meeting requirements of town councils in certain towns.

[01:56:49] Legislation reporting on county, cities, and towns with an amendment of nature of substitute. Delegate McAuliffe. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Delegate McAuliffe, Delegate McAuliffe. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:57:04] By moving that committee substitute, the body very wisely conformed this bill to HB 505, which has already passed out of the body with bipartisan support. The bill would simply ensure that any local elected official who previously worked for an agency under that local government is prohibited from voting on matters related to their former placement point for two years after leaving that position.

[01:57:23] And I hope it be the will of the body to pass the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 70.

[01:57:38] Nose. 26. Ayes. 70. Nose. 26. The bill passes. Senate Bill 742, now before you seek to amend and reenact a section of the Code of Virginia relating to removal of clutter, agricultural use exemption, Planning District 19. Legislation was reported from the Committee on Counties, Cities, and Towns.

[01:57:55] Delegate from Denton Whitty, Delegate Pope Adams. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB 742 is identical to HB 1316 and clarifies that only in Planning District 19, clutter ordinances do not apply to land zone for agricultural unless the parcel is one acre or less and used for residential purposes.

[01:58:13] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? That's you. Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 79, noes 19.

[01:58:30] Ayes 79, noes 19. The bill passes. Senate Bill 98, now before you would direct the Secretary of Public Safety and Homeland Security to convene a work group to evaluate existing emergency management needs in the Commonwealth report. Legislation was reported on the Committee on Appropriations. Delegate from Virginia Beach. Delegate, ask you.

[01:58:46] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move SB 98. Go by for the day. The Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate, I can move to SB 98, go by for the day. As many of the favor, the motion say aye. Those opposed, no. SB 98 is aye for the day. And Senate Bill 692 now before you. This is a different legislation.

[01:59:02] This one seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to a Western Public Education Consortium, governance, funding, and duties. Legislation report here on appropriations with an amendment in nature of substitute. The Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, I move that Senate Bill 692 go by for the day.

[01:59:20] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon, who's a Senate Bill 692, go by for the day. As many favor the most, say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The bill's by for the day. Mr. Speaker, we now go back and pick up a couple of the bills that were moved earlier over on page one, if you're following that way. Senate Bill 3 is now before you, and it would establish the Employee Child Care Assistance Program.

[01:59:42] This legislation was reported to the Committee on Appropriations with an amendment in nature substitute. Delegate from Arlington, Delegate McClure. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the committee substitute conforms the bill to mind, so I move that we adopt the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to.

[01:59:58] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. SB3 is now identical to my HB18, which passed this body on a vote of 91 to 7, and it would establish the Employee Child Care Assistance Program to support businesses in making child care more affordable for their employees. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:00:23] Ayes 94, nos 4. Ayes 94, nos 4. The bill passes. Over on page two of the printed calendar, we come next to Senate Bill 88. This is legislation that seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia later into reapportionment, reallocation of populations, civil commitment facilities.

[02:00:42] This legislation is reporting on privileges and elections, and Delegate Price has a floor substitute. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I move that this bill go by for the day. The Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price, move that SB 88 go by for the day.

[02:00:59] Many favors the motion say aye. Those opposed, no. The SB 88 is by for today. Remaining on page 3, page 2, excuse me, Senate Bill 134 now before you is legislation that seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia related to public education, early childhood care, and education, child care access calculation report.

[02:01:21] Legislation reporting on appropriations with amendment nature substitute. Delegate for Prince William. Delegate Sewell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the Appropriations Committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. The delegate for Prince William, Delegate Sewell.

[02:01:36] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The substitute brings SB 134 in alignment with my House Bill 1208, which passed the body. This bill moves the Commonwealth one step closer to establishing a standardized and transparent method for estimating the annual funding needed for child care.

[02:01:53] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes.

[02:02:10] 93, no's 3. Ayes 93, noes 3, the bill passes. Over on page 3, we pick up Senate Bill 140, which is legislation to amend and reenact Section of Dakota, Virginia, relating to the Department of Fire Programs, mental health awareness training, legislation reporting committee on appropriations with the amendment nature of substitute.

[02:02:26] They're from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, SB 140 is identical to MI 325, which passed this body 90 to 7, so check your votes.

[02:02:44] The bill directs VDFP to develop an online mental health awareness module that's available to all firefighters, emergency medical service providers, and communication officers across the Commonwealth. I move that the bill pass. Shall the bill pass? Close the roll.

[02:03:10] Ayes. 95, nos, 2. Ayes 95, nos, 2. The bill passes. Over on page 5, we pick up Senate Bill 286, which is legislation to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia relating to the Department of Human Resource Management state government internship coordinator.

[02:03:32] This legislation was reported for the committee on appropriations with an amendment and a nature of substitute. And, Mr. Speaker, as a member of the House, Delegate Sullivan has floor amendments that are distributed via IHOD to the members here in the chamber and the public via the legislative information system.

[02:03:49] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those

opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to the delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this bill, affectionately known as the Internship Bill, establishes a state government internship coordinator and moves the COVA Internship Connection Program out of a pilot phase and becomes the responsibility of DHRM.

[02:04:13] It's meant to expand the capacity of DHRM to properly focus on the effort to build a workforce pipeline. I have an amendment. I'll move the amendments. Shall the floor amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The floor amendments are agreed to. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan.

[02:04:30] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Amendments two and three are suggestions from the AG's office, which simply clarify by changing the word state agency to state government. And amendment number one clarifies that interns aren't limited to coming from universities. With that, it's identical to my HB 54, which passed unanimously, and I move that the bill pass.

[02:04:48] I guess I have to move the amendments, please, first. We already have. Shall the bill pass? Don't do my job, bro. Do my job. Scary thought, Mr. Speaker. The clerk will close the roll.

[02:05:04] Ayes, 90, noes, 3. Ayes, 90, noes, 3. The bill passes. Over on page 7, we pick up Senate Bill 403. Senate Bill 403 is legislation to amend the Code of Virginia relating to the Power Transformer Manufacturing Grant Fund.

[02:05:23] This legislation was reported from the Committee on Appropriations. The delegate for Prince William, Delegate Torrey. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Senate Bill 403 is identical to my House Bill 799, which passed out this House. This bill codifies the MAI Commission-approved economic development project for Hitachi to build large power transformers in Fairfax County.

[02:05:45] The company will create 825 jobs and invest $457 million in Fairfax County. Mr. Speaker, I move passes of the bill. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[02:06:07] Ayes 92, no's 4. Ayes 92, no's 4. The bill passes. And over on page 9, we come to the last bill in this category, Senate Bill 800. Is legislation amended and reenacted, a portion of the Acts of the Assembly of 1964, relating to the Winchester Parking Authority Act?

[02:06:23] Is legislation reporting on counties, cities, and towns? The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, I move that SB 800 go by for the day. The delegate from Fairfax moves that SB 800 go by for the day. Is there any favors to say aye? Aye. Those opposed, no. SB 800 is by for the day. Right.

[02:06:40] Mr. Speaker, next in the calendar, if you're following along that way, page 22, House bills on secondary and regular. That's subject to a special continuing order by the Chairman of Appropriations, so we'll take that up. take that up tomorrow, but I simply mentioned in passing earlier, I said there were four floor amendments to that. Those floor amendments have been released, so they're available to the public and to the members if you're so inclined. Continuing with today's calendar, we come to the final section, which is House bills with Senate amendments. House bills with Senate amendments, 17 or so in this category, beginning at the bottom of the page, 22, delegate prices, House Bill 6. This legislation relates to contraception, right to contraception,

[02:07:20] applicability, enforcement. Legislation originally passed the House. Substitute passed the Senate with a substitute, and that substitute's now before you. The delegate for Newport News, Delegate

Price. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate added some amendments that I would like to continue to work on in conference, so I move that we accept the Senate amendments, and I ask that the members vote no. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[02:07:44] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 1. No's 96. Ayes 1. No's 96. Senate substitute is rejected. Next up, Delegate Reeser, House Bill 125 now before you.

[02:08:04] As legislation relates to public elementary and secondary schools, teachers, terms of employment, re-employment of teacher who has not received continuing contract status, written notice required. Legislation originally passed the House, substitute passed the Senate with a substitute, which is now before you. Delegate from Lyon County, Delegate Reeser. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[02:08:19] The Senate substituted the result of punctuation difference in this bill that ensures tenured teachers' due process rights may not be circumvented. Mr. Speaker, I move the House agree to the Senate substitute and I ask the members vote no. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:08:46] Ayes 0, noes 97. Ayes 0, noes 97. Senate substitute is rejected. House Bill 165 as legislation relates to the Board of Contractors, Examinations, Alternative Languages. Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with an amendment, which is now before you.

[02:09:04] The delegate for Perth Williams, Delegate Thomas. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the Senate amendment changes the code site from the Federal Voting Rights Act to the State Voting Rights Act, which continues to make sure the General Assembly controls the language threshold by which we allow contractor exams to be taken.

[02:09:20] I move adoption of the Senate amendments and ask that we say yes. Shall the Senate amendment be adopted?

[02:09:35] Close the roll. Ayes. 92, no's 4. House 92, notes 4, the Senate amendment is adopted. House Bill 182 relates to high school graduation requirements, history and social study credit substitutions permitted.

[02:09:53] Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with a substitute. That amendment is substituted by the Senate. It's not before you. Doug, from Loudoun County, Doug, you read. Yes, thank you, Mr. Speaker. As you probably remember, this is the legislation that allows AP, African American Studies, and African-American history to be substituted for World History I or World Geography.

[02:10:11] The Senate added to this a section that would require that a student shall be required to complete and receive a passing score on an appropriate local alternative assessment so that it would be a verified credit for graduation, and I ask the body to accept the Senate substitute.

[02:10:28] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[02:10:42] Close the roll. Ayes, 65. Noes, 32. Ayes, 65. Noes, 32. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 191, now before you, relates to victims of sex trafficking, minors, immunity to arrest or prosecution for prostitution.

[02:11:02] Legislation originally passed the House, subsequently passed the Senate with an amendment. That Senate amendment is before you. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Cummings Fowler. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The amendment to HB 191 is simply technical in nature, aiming to specify procedures for law enforcement. So, Mr. Speaker, I ask that we accept the Senate amendment.

[02:11:19] Shall the Senate amendment be adopted?

[02:11:28] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 9D6, no's 1. Ayes, 96, no's 1. The Senate amendment is adopted. Over on page 24, we come to House Bill 201, which relates to school board policies, parental notification, safe storage of prescription drugs and firearms in the household.

[02:11:54] Legislation originally passed the House. That Senate was substituted. That Senate substitutes now before you. Delegate from Fairfax. Delegate Cohen. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. In this case, the Senate got it right and added on that current statistics published by the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention or an equivalent nationally recognized entity or organization on youth firearm fatality rates to the notification that would be sent out.

[02:12:17] So I ask my colleagues to please accept, by pressing yes, the substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes.

[02:12:33] 64, noes. 33. Ayes. 64, noes. 33. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 276 relates to members of the Virginia State Bar rules and regulations relating to schedule of fees. Legislation rules to pass the House, to pass the Senate with amendments, Senate amendments before you.

[02:12:50] Delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, I would ask that we reject the Senate amendments by voting no. We have reached an agreement, but we didn't reach an agreement in time for the Senate to do the amendment.

[02:13:07] So I would ask that we reject. Thank you. Shall the Senate amendment be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:13:23] Ayes, zero, nos, 97. Ayes, zero, nos, 97. The Senate amendment is rejected. Top of page 25, we come to House Bill 332. H.B. 332 relates to teacher licensure, three-year renewal license to teach career and technical education or dual enrollment courses at public high schools.

[02:13:43] Legislation register, pass the House, pass the Senate with substitutes, Senate substitutes now before you. Delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 332 is about dual enrollment teachers, increasing them in public high schools. The Senate amendment, Senate substitutes merely technical in nature.

[02:13:59] I hope we accept the Senate substitute. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[02:14:12] Close the roll. Ayes 96, no zero. Ayes 96, no zero. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 396, now before you, relates to charitable gaming, Texas Hold'em poker tournaments. Legislation originally passed the House, passed that with the substitute, which is now before you.

[02:14:29] Delegate Crescent. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The Senate laid the Senate Bill 765 on top of my bill. Rejecting the Senate substitute will put House Bill 396 back into the posture, which had originally passed this body, maintaining the age of 21, venue location rules and payment methods for charitable Texas Hold'em Poker Tournament.

[02:14:49] So, Mr. Speaker, I would move the Senate substitute and ask that we reject the Senate substitute and request a committee of conference. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:15:08] Ayes 4, noes 93. Ayes 4, noes 93. Senate substitute is rejected. House Bill 584 is now before you. It relates to Western Virginia Public Education Consortium governance funding duties. Legislation

originally passed the House.

[02:15:24] Subject passed the Senate with the substitute, which is before you. Delegate Ballard. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, members of the body. The Senate substitute would make my bill identical to SB 692, which we just passed by for the day. The differences are very minor, just in the language. So I would move the Senate substitute and ask the body to reject it.

[02:15:43] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 2, noes 95. Ayes 2, noes 95.

[02:15:59] The Senate substitute is rejected. Next up, House Bill 595, which relates to the Board of Education, requirements for graduation with an advanced studies diploma, simultaneous completion of international baccalaureate diploma and advanced studies diploma, approval of alternatives for certain credit requirements.

[02:16:15] Congratulations, Richard Pastell. Substitute with the substitute, which is before you. Newport News, Delegate Simons. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 595 helps IB students who transfer into Virginia schools after 10th grade meet the requirements for an advanced studies diploma. The Senate amendments add clarifying language to direct the Department of Education to produce these regulations, and I hope we will accept the Senate substitute.

[02:16:39] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Close the roll. Ayes. 93, nos, 2. House 93, No. 2, the Senate substitute is adopted.

[02:16:55] Over on page 26, we come to House Bill 671, which relates to jurors, exemptions from jury service upon request, competency to perform jury duty. Legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate with an amendment, which is now before. Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Maldonado.

[02:17:11] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the amendment is a simple fix to reinstate language that was mistakenly stricken. I ask that we move the Senate amendment and adopt, saying yes. Shall the Senate Amendment be adopted? Ayes 97, noes 0.

[02:17:37] Ayes 97, noes 0. The Senate Amendment is adopted. House Bill 705 would require the Board of Education to include a program of instruction on water safety in its next regularly scheduled revision of the Health Education Standards of Learning and Curriculum Framework. Legislation originally passed the House, let's pass the Senate with a substitute which is before you.

[02:17:54] Now from Chesapeake, Doug at Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 705 requires that the Board of Education to develop and make available to each school board guidelines for programs of instruction for water safety for elementary school students. Initially, the House wisely removed the enactment dates from the bill, but the other body down the hall added them back.

[02:18:17] Mr. Speaker, I move that the Senate substitute and ask that we vote no. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[02:18:34] Clerk will close the roll. Aye, aye. Zero, no's 97. Zero, no's 97, the Senate substitute is rejected. House Bill 933, next up, relates to penalties for failure to appear contempt.

[02:18:50] Legislation originally passed the House, passed the Senate substitute, Senate substitute is before you. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, this bill started

out as a really excellent and strong bill that we sent over to the Senate. It comes back a weaker, less effective bill, but it still makes progress. This has nothing to do with felony failure to appear.

[02:19:06] This retains a felony for failure to appear, but it does actually improve the definition of willfulness and limits convictions for failure to appear to those willful failures to appear. So it gets us moving in the right direction. It's not as good as the bill that I would have liked to have, but I don't see this going to get any better in conference. And so with that, I reluctantly move the amendments and ask that the members vote yes.

[02:19:25] Shall the Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the vote. Ayes. 64, noes 32. Ayes 64, noes 32.

[02:19:40] The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 1147 would direct the Board of Medicine and Board of Nursing to require certain licensees to complete bias reduction training as part of their continuing education and continuing compensating requirements for licensure. Legislation originally passed the House, House Senate, and that Senate substitutes before you.

[02:19:58] Chesapeake, Doug at Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 1147 directs the Board of Medicine and Board of Nursing to require certain licenses to complete continuing learning activities on implicit and explicit bias reduction in health care as part of their continuing education and continuing competency requirements for licensure.

[02:20:17] The substitute adds some clarifying language aligning my bill together with Senate Bill 22, and I move the Senate substitute, and I ask that we vote yes. Should the Senate substitute be adopted?

[02:20:40] Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 64, noes, 33. Ayes, 64, noes, 33. The Senate substitute is adopted. House Bill 1278 relates to school board policies, communication and language accessibility for limited English proficient parents requirements.

[02:20:59] Legislation originally passed to the House, subsequently passed to Senate, and that Senate substitutes before you. Deb from Long County, Delegate Risa. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill codifies the existing obligations that schools provide, translation and interpretation for limited English proficiency parents. The Senate substitution adds back VDOE administrative and staffing requirements, which were originally removed from this bill in appropriations.

[02:21:22] So we would like to go to conference and work out the differences. So, Mr. Speaker, I move that the House agree to the Senate substitute, and I ask that they vote no on the motion. Shall a Senate substitute be adopted? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:21:47] Ayes 1, noes 95. Ayes 1, noes 95. Senate substitute is rejected. And lastly, we come to House Bill 1347, which would direct the Board of Pharmacy to promulgate regulations that allow for the prescribing, possessing, and dispensing and use of psilocybin.

[02:22:05] Legislation originally passed the House. It's passed Senate with substitutes. Senate substitutes before you. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cohen. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'm hoping that you all won't have to say psilocybin one more time after we do this. This substitute on HB 1347 came from the Board of Pharmacy and will finally conform the Senate and House versions.

[02:22:25] I ask my colleague to accept the substitute by voting yes. Shall the Senate substitute be adopted?

[02:22:42] Ayes, 96, noes, 0. Ayes, 96, noes, 0. The Senate substitute is adopted. Mr. Speaker, that completes today's calendar. The information in the Senate bills in conference and House bills in conference is informational only.

[02:23:00] For House Rule 51, the House has returned to the morning hour. Does the clerk have any additional announcements or communications? No, no communications, just simple announcements for the meeting schedule. Just remind the body that next Tuesday is a revenue bill and the budget bill deadline.

[02:23:17] So revenue bills, there is a list of those that we're working through to make sure we're all in the proper posture in past. So accordingly, we look at today, this Wednesday afternoon, 2:15-ish when we'll adjourn. So the first meeting will be Committee on Finance will be meeting 15 minutes upon adjournment of the House in House Committee Room B. So that's the full Committee on Finance, 15 minutes upon adjournment of the House. Likewise, Committee on Appropriations, they'll be meeting up on the 12th floor in the House Appropriations Committee Room. 15 minutes upon adjournment of the finance committee the courts of justice criminal sub will be meeting

[02:23:56] they'll be in house committee room c um uh then uh 15 minutes upon adjournment of the finance committee the uh courts of justice civil subcommittee they'll be down the hall on the second floor of the house uh north subcommittee room uh so the finance approves and then the two subs of uh courts will be meeting at four o'clock transportations highway safety and a policy um subcommittee will be meeting. They're going to be in House Committee Room A in the lower level, and then the last activity this afternoon is LGBTQIA plus caucus, which will not be meeting,

[02:24:35] so we'll update that accordingly. Therefore, we're looking ahead to tomorrow. Thursday, February 26th, the Capitol Commission prayer meeting is at 6.30, followed by the Bible study at 7 up in the 14th floor of the Speaker's conference room. Legislative Sportsman's Caucus is meeting tomorrow at 7 a.m., 7th floor House North Meeting Room, so it's on the 7th floor.

[02:24:58] Hampton Roads Caucus is meeting at 7.30 tomorrow. They're going to be in the South Subcommittee Room on the 7th floor there. So prayers and a couple caucuses to start the day. And then at 8.30, Committee on Health and Human Services, Social Services Subcommittee will be meeting in House Committee Room C on the 2nd floor.

[02:25:20] Once that subcommittee is finished, then the full committee will take up its docket at 9.30. The Aviation Caucus is meeting at 8 a.m. Back in time, I apologize. They're going to be on the Senate subcommittee room 600 north, so they'll be on the sixth floor.

[02:25:37] Back at 8 o'clock as well, the Committee on Public Safety subcommittee number two, they're going to be meeting at 8 a.m. in the House North subcommittee room on the second floor. And then at 9, tomorrow, the Committee on Transportation, the full Committee on Transportation's meeting at 9 o'clock.

[02:25:53] They'll be in House Committee Room B. Then the two caucuses will be meeting before we go into session. The Democratic caucus is at 11.15. The Republican caucus will be at 11. Democrats in House Room 1, Republicans in House Room 2.

[02:26:09] We'll update the schedule accordingly. Just remember, tomorrow is Budget Day, so we may be here for a while to be determined. But just leave all your documents here that you'll need for tomorrow. And your objections will be due by 11 tomorrow. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring.

[02:26:26] Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, adjourn to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon. Delegate from Alexandria moves that when the House adjourns today, adjourn to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon. As many in favor of the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. Delegate from Alexandria, the motion is agreed to the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring.

[02:26:44] Mr. Speaker, I move that the House do now adjourn. Then from Alexander, I move that the House will not adjourn. If any of the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The House stands adjourned until tomorrow at 12 noon.

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